

Samsung Unveils 3GB HDD Smartphone

On March 11, at the CeBIT 2005 show in Hanover, Germany, Samsung announced the world's first phone with a 7-megapixel digital camera. The SCH-V770 has 3x optical zoom, a flash, full manual mode, 1/2000 shutter speed, and the scope to add additional lenses.



Apple To Join Blu-ray Forum

Apple will join the Blu-ray forum to offer support for Sony's next-gen DVDs and to enable its own customers to develop higher-quality videos. The addition of Apple on the board of the Blu-ray Association could help decide the format to replace standard DVDs.



Enter

Dr Edward deBono
Thinker and Author

Dr Edward deBono, Rhodes scholar to Oxford, PhD from Cambridge and MD (University of Malta) is one of the world's foremost 'thinkers', and has authored over sixty books—translated into 34 languages—on 'lateral thinking' methods. He has also worked with such corporations as IBM, Du Pont, AT&T, NTT (Japan), Ericsson (Sweden), Siemens, and Microsoft.

What does technology mean to you?

Technological advancements have made it possible for us to get to places much faster, use PCs to write, and e-mail to communicate with people more efficiently.

What kind of gadgets do you normally use?

I use the PC to write my books, and to compose and send e-mails. The only other gadget I use is a shaver!

How do you interact with technology on a day-to-day basis?

I don't browse the Web too much but I listen to the radio and watch the news on TV.

Do you feel the surfeit of information on the Web is hampering normal thought processes? Are people thinking enough?

The Net has made it possible for people to obtain vast amounts of information. Children find answers easily to several questions. But they need to be taught and encouraged to think for themselves and use the information in a productive manner.

CHAINING MELODY

Music Download Prices Set To Rise

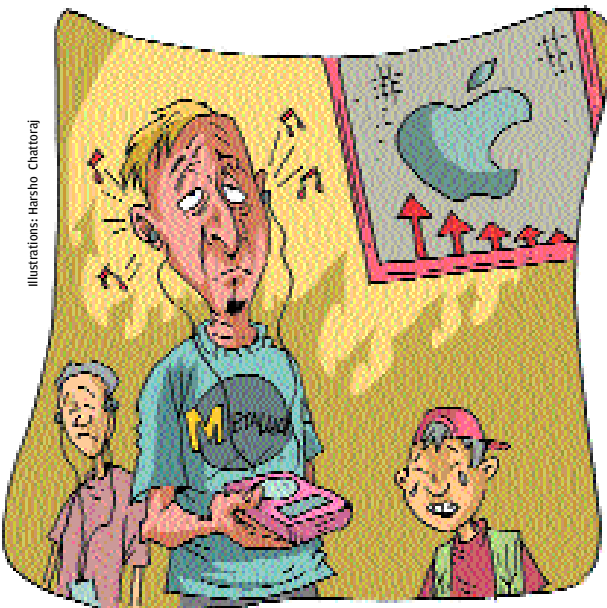
The market for downloaded music is strong enough to take a price rise, according to most major music labels in Europe and the US.

Several big labels are in talks with online music

observers are concerned that increasing prices would push people back to peer-to-peer networks and dodgy copies of songs.

The music industry is apparently unhappy with Apple's increasing

the European Commission is investigating allegations that British consumers are being ripped off by Apple's iTunes service because it charges more for downloads from the UK site and does not allow customers to buy tracks from other iTunes sites.



Illustrations: Harsho Chatteraj

retailers to get them to increase prices, according to a story in London's *Financial Times* (FT). Labels are looking to increase the wholesale prices shops pay for tracks. Sites in the US typically sell tracks for 99 cents each (Rs 43). The wholesale price is currently 65 cents (Rs 28) per track, according to FT.

Universal and Sony BMG are less keen to push prices up. EMI and Time Warner, in fact, refused to comment on the FT story. Some

share of the market—the firm sells about 65 per cent of songs sold online. The arrival of cheaper iPods is likely to give the firm an even larger share of the market. Apple refused to comment on the story but Steve Jobs is reportedly deeply unhappy with the attempted price hike.

One suggestion is that labels want to introduce variable pricing—so they can charge more for top-selling tracks. Meanwhile,

PIZZA ON YOUR PHONE

Two Companies, A Talking Browser And A Pizza Place

If phone makers get their way, pretty soon, we'll all tote little Web browsers in our pockets, whipping them out 10 times a day instead of running back to a desktop screen. Sounds great, until you try to navigate Mr Pizza Man's online menu on your cell phone's tiny screen. By the time you've thumb-typed or stylus-tapped your way through the dozens of yummy options, you could have ordered a hundred pizzas the old-fashioned way. Wouldn't this all be easier if you could talk to your browser like it was the pizza guy?

It certainly would, based on a test drive of the Opera browser for Windows,